

Uepaki — Seller Acquisition Master Launch Playbook

The one operating plan: who, how, in what order, what it costs, when to stop

Prepared for Sahil Mittal, Founder

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Operative files: this playbook · UEPAKI_SELLER_ACQUISITION_COMMAND_CENTER.xlsx · UEPAKI_FINAL_SELLER_ACQUISITION_CHECKLIST.md · UEPAKI_SELLER_ACQUISITION_RED_TEAM_AUDIT.pdf. All other documents are reference (§12).

1. Status and verdict

AMBER. The acquisition logic is sound. The weak points are in the seller journey and in terms the professional meets after saying yes. Start the Wave -1 journey test now (once the Refer & Earn redirect is removed). Start cold outreach only after the Gate 0 items in §3 are closed.

Realism. Uepaki has no conversion history. On the system's own test rates, cold outreach converts roughly **1–5% of contacted professionals into activated professionals**. This is arithmetic on test thresholds, not a forecast. Plan for a small, real, complementary founding community at launch. Do not plan for hundreds.

Legacy sellers. The founder confirms existing registrations are 3–5 years old and none is active. They are:

- **not** counted as “joined”;
- **not** an acquisition channel;
- **not** to take founding seats.

They receive only the legally required terms-migration notice. Whether dormant profiles are hidden from customers at launch is a founder decision (G9).

2. The system on one page

Question	Answer
Who first	Golden 300 v2 (§4). Commercially active, recently active, directly contactable professionals, with emerging professionals at 20% or more and under-discovered professionals favoured. Four anchor cities: Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Jaipur. Product-capable categories lead until service features at launch are confirmed
Why them	They have the most to gain from an additional channel, the least gatekeeping, a verified 1:1 route, and complementary peers in the same city. Fame is not an input
Channel	1:1, human-written email to the business address on their own website, or a direct message from Uepaki's

Question	Answer
	professional Instagram. LinkedIn for architecture and design practices. WhatsApp only when the professional invites it. AiSensy only after a recorded opt-in. No calls to wedding-platform numbers
Proposition	"A marketplace launching in India where customers can buy products and connect with creative professionals for services, bookings and projects. Before launch we're inviting a few [peers] in [city]." Plus the FP-OUT founding sentence. No promise of customers, ranking or income. Never "free" (registration is ₹1 + GST)
Sequence	Wave -1 journey test → Wave 0 pilot (25) → Wave 1 founding cohort (to 100) → Wave 2 expansion (to 300) → Wave 3 enrichment and reserve → Wave 4 launch window. Each wave starts only on the previous wave's exit criteria
Measure	Activated professionals (north star), then transacting professionals. Every rate cohort-based, in the Command Center
Stop	Reply rate below 10% after 40 delivered; bounce above 5%; opt-out/complaint above 2% or any platform warning; approved → activated below 50% (fix onboarding before adding volume)
Scale	Reply rate of 20% or more with activations, over 40 or more contacts. Double that cell's weekly allocation, within onboarding capacity only

3. Gate 0 — readiness (before any cold contact)

Gate	What "closed" means	Owner	Needed before
G6	Sign-up no longer redirects to Refer & Earn	Engineering	Wave -1
G2	5–10 friendly professionals (founder's network; products and services) complete registration (₹1 + GST) → KYC → approval → profile → listing → payout details on the live system. Every defect is logged and fixed or scripted	Founder + Engineering	Wave 0
G1	FP-OUT short and long wording approved	Founder	Wave 0
G3	One-page interim information note approved. It is known what terms a seller accepts at registration today, and they are acceptable to send people into	Founder + Legal	Wave 0
G4	Policy for sellers without a verified GSTIN (orders are blocked in code). Until decided, Wave 0 favours GST-registered businesses and tells others honestly	Founder + CA	Wave 0
G7	One approved page/link (what Uepaki is, its stage, the founder's name). Domain email. Uepaki Instagram with real content before any DM	Founder	Wave 0
G13	SPF, DKIM and DMARC set on the sending domain	Founder / IT	Wave 0
G5	U-1 decided: can free sellers withdraw earnings?	Founder	Wave 1
G8	Lawyer view on the outreach and consent method	Legal	Wave 1
G9	Legacy accounts: excluded from counts and founding seats; decision on hiding dormant profiles; terms-migration notice	Founder + Engineering + Legal	Wave 0 (exclusion) / launch
G10	FP-QUAL: founding seat = registration + approval + first live listing (recommended)	Founder	Wave 1
G11	EV-09: service/booking features at launch; U-5 (are intracity bookings premium?)	Engineering + Founder	Wave 1 (services)
G12	Consent-to-be-named field and the Verified Professional Register	Operations	Wave 1
G14	Optional: may the exact policy sentence on paid placement be used proactively?	Founder	Optional

The Command Center's BLOCKERS sheet tracks these and computes the verdict.

4. Who to approach: the Golden 300 v2

The red team found that the v1 lists over-selected saturated, stockist-backed labels and established brands, under-selected emerging professionals, and spread across ten cities. v2 corrects this, and is pre-filled in the Command Center.

Selection rule. From 1,538 contact-ready professionals (OS-P0/P1, verified own-site or professional-social route, no open research flags):

- **Exclude:** established/multi-store brands; brand-demand-dependent creators (held to Wave 4).
- **Score:** $0.6 \times \text{readiness percentile within category} + 0.25 \times \text{founding potential} + 0.15 \times \text{network}$.
 - +6 if under-discovered;
 - +4 if emerging (tier A);
 - +2 if active in the last 3 months; – 6 if stockist-listed with a large catalogue; – 2 if tier C.
- **Tier A floor:** 20% of each category quota.

- **Segment cap:** no segment takes more than ~45% of its category.
- **Cities:** Delhi NCR and Mumbai for the pilot; four anchor cities for the 300.

	Fashion & Lifestyle	Space & Design	Digital & Visual Arts	Beauty & Makeup	Lens & Motion	Content & Media	Total
Wave 0 (1–25)	6	6	3	4	4	2	25
Wave 1 (to 100)	28	22	12	16	16	6	100
Wave 2 (to 300)	80	65	35	50	50	20	300

Composition of the 300:

- tier A 84 / B 176 / C 40; no tier D/E;
- under-discovered 56;
- service categories 40%;
- Delhi NCR 151 · Mumbai 92 · Bengaluru 30 · Jaipur 27;
- OS-P0 237.

Known limits. Fashion records came mostly from stockist designer indexes, so even v2 Fashion picks are stockist-listed. Delhi NCR dominates because supply is deepest there. Beauty in the anchor cities has only ~59 contact-ready records, so further Beauty depends on enrichment (13_ENRICHMENT_QUEUE, 250 records).

Premium/aspirational (69 tier D/E): never cold. Wave 4, warm introduction only, after a complete pod exists in their category and city.

5. Channels and messages

Use the red-team rewrites for every first message (Red Team Audit §4): email no longer than 110 words; DM no longer than 300 characters; low-friction CTA (“Shall I send a one-page note? A one-word reply is enough.”). The Message Engine’s M3, the segment lines and the objection replies remain valid.

Cold sequence: M1 (Day 0) → M2 (Day 5) → M4 final note (Day 12) → stop; no contact for 75 days. One channel at a time. The Command Center calculates every due date.

Channel limits (initial test thresholds):

- 10 or fewer new emails per sender per day;
- 15–20 or fewer new Instagram DMs per day per account (only once the account has real content);
- no automation tools.

Objections. Answer from the Seller Objection Playbook. The five that matter most:

Question	The core of the answer
“Who else is on Uepaki?”	Live count of activated professionals (legacy accounts excluded) plus consented names; honest about the stage; pods
“Will I get customers?”	“I can’t promise customers; nobody honestly can before launch. Uepaki’s job is to bring customers to the marketplace; we’ll help make your listings strong.”
“Is it free?”	“Registration is ₹1 + GST on the website. Under Uepaki’s policy, no subscription is needed to register, list products or accept ordinary orders; paid plans add specific extras.”
“Commission?”	In the written terms; never a figure from memory
“Is organic reach paid?” (only when asked)	“Uepaki’s policy is that there’s no paid placement, and a subscription doesn’t buy higher organic ranking.” Never “cannot be bought”; never mechanics

Never:

- the word “free” for registration;
- promises of customers or ranking;
- invented numbers or names;
- competitor names;
- referral rewards;
- un-cleared founding numbers;
- a launch date;
- cold WhatsApp.

6. From interest to activation

Activated = approved (KYC and store) + profile complete + at least one live listing + payout details + good standing.

The 15-minute set-up call is the core conversion tool. Within 24 hours of interest:

1. Readiness check:
 - category and first listing type (products only in Fashion, Space, Digital);
 - **GSTIN status**;
 - PAN and bank details;
 - images to hand;
 - consents (named / social / WhatsApp, each separate).
2. Register together (web path), including the ₹1 + GST payment.
3. Agree the first listing.

After approval, the onboarding lead drafts the profile (approval + 24 hours) and the first listing (approval + 48 hours) from the professional's own work, for their sign-off. An unblock call follows at approval + 72 hours.

Escalation:

- **L1 onboarding lead** — same day.
- **L2 founder** — terms, fees, GST/KYC policy, complaints.
- **L3 engineering** — defects; update the professional every 48 hours.
- **Legal team** — serious cases and appeals (Q-REVIEWER).

Never: tax advice; promises about payout timing; “complete your profile to rank higher”.

Checklists: Onboarding Playbook §4. Tracking: Command Center PROSPECTS.

7. The founding offer and “who has joined?”

What can be said now (until FP-OUT): “We are forming a founding group of professionals. The written terms are being finalised, and I’ll share them before you decide.”

What the founder has decided (S07, not yet public-cleared):

- first 500 sellers;
- a lifetime 2-point commission reduction;
- promotion on four social channels via Creator Advantage;
- **no organic-visibility advantage.**

Recommended: seats count only on activation (FP-QUAL), so legacy and abandoned sign-ups cannot consume them. Operational benefits Uepaki can deliver:

- assisted set-up;
- a named contact;
- one monthly founding session (not one per category — founder time is the bottleneck).

No referral rewards (E4 deferred); unpaid, consent-based peer introductions only, asked at activation and after a first transaction.

“Who has joined?” ladder:

Stage	Condition	What may be said
Stage 0	Fewer than 10 activated	Process and exact count
Stage 1	First pods	Counts by category plus consented names
Stage 2	Complete pods in 2 or more cities	City × category coverage; offers to introduce a founding professional
Stage 3	After launch	Real, consented stories

Founder approves any public number. Legacy dormant accounts are never counted.

8. The 30 / 60 / 90-day plan

Day 1 = the day this plan is adopted. The tentative launch date (internal only) falls at about day 85. If Gate 0 slips, every period slips with it. **Do not compress waves to protect a date.**

Days 1–30 — Prove the journey, then pilot

Item	Plan
Target segments	Wave –1: 5–10 friendly professionals from the founder's network across products and services. Wave 0: Golden 300 v2 ranks 1–25 (Delhi NCR 18, Mumbai 7; 13 emerging; 10 service)
Channels	Wave –1: in person / call. Wave 0: founder email (C1) and Instagram DM (C3)
Campaign waves	Days 1–10: Gate 0 sprint + Wave –1. Days 11–14: Gate review. Days 15–30: Wave 0 (5 first contacts per working day over a week; sequences complete by about day 28)
Workload (estimate; replace with timings from Wave –1)	Founder: decisions G1/G3/G4/G5/G9; Wave –1 calls; Wave 0 first notes, about 10–15 min each (~6 h); calls with interested professionals. Ops/onboarding lead: Wave –1 hand-holding; route verification; tracker; set-up calls
KPIs	Gates closed. Wave –1 participants reaching activation (or a logged defect explaining why). Wave 0: delivered, replies, interested, set-up calls, registrations, activations, objections logged verbatim, minutes per step
Budget	Tier 0–1 only: domain email and authentication; a simple approved page; phone/data. No paid tools or ads
Stop / continue	Stop Wave 0 if Wave –1 shows a journey-breaking defect that isn't fixed. Fewer than 4 replies from 25: rewrite the frame before Wave 1 (directional only). Any complaint about spam: review the sender identity (G7)
Activation goals	Every willing Wave –1 professional activated; first cold-to-activated professionals from Wave 0. No numeric target
Review cadence	Daily 15-minute stand-up. Friday 60-minute review. Gate review on day 14

Days 31–60 — Form the first pods

Item	Plan
Target segments	Wave 1: ranks 26–100 across four anchor cities, product-capable categories first. Service categories only if G11 is closed; otherwise only service anchors (pods need at least one photographer and one MUA per city)
Channels	Email; Instagram DM; LinkedIn for practices. Peer introductions from activated professionals (with consent). WhatsApp only when invited
Campaign waves	Wave 1 in weekly pod batches: one city, complementary segments, about 15–20 contacts a week. Enrichment sprint (find professional Instagram/email for top Beauty and Content records). C2 re-check sprint (116 Space & Design routes). E03 CTA test (reply-for-note vs call)
Workload	Outreach lead: ~15–20 personalised first contacts a week, replies, follow-ups. Onboarding lead: set-up calls as interest arrives (capacity rule: new contacts per week $\leq$ set-up calls available $\div$ observed interest rate). Founder: anchors and tier C notes, L2 escalations, one founding session, decisions G10/G11
KPIs	Activated by city $\times$ category; pods complete (minimum composition); interested $\rightarrow$ registered; approved $\rightarrow$ activated; median approval days; consent-to-be-named rate; GST-flagged professionals
Budget	Tier 0–1. Travel for in-person meetings with anchors in Delhi NCR/Mumbai if it accelerates pods. AiSensy only if 50 or more professionals have opted in (Tier 2)
Stop / continue	Campaign rules (§11). Any category above 30% of activated: slow it. Approved $\rightarrow$ activated below 50%: pause new contacts, fix onboarding
Activation goals	At least one complete Wedding & Occasion or Home & Space pod in Delhi NCR and Mumbai. No numeric total target
Review cadence	Daily stand-up. Weekly review. Monthly founding update to activated professionals

Days 61–90 — Expand carefully, prepare launch

Item	Plan
Target segments	Wave 2: ranks 101–300 (anchor cities), only if Wave 1 met its exit criteria. Wave 3: enriched Beauty/Content records and the founding reserve to fill pod gaps. Wedding-service bulk outreach waits until after peak season; anchors only during it
Channels	Proven channels only (from the dashboard). Opted-in WhatsApp updates (AiSensy templates T01–T06). PR coordination with consented founding professionals (PR strategy)
Campaign waves	Wave 2 at a pace set by onboarding capacity. Wave 4 preparation: identify premium names whose pods are complete; arrange warm introductions for the launch window
Workload	As days 31–60, plus launch preparation (onboarding help for listings, the “who has joined?” Stage 1–2 summary, founder approval of public numbers)
KPIs	Activated and transacting (after launch); time-to-activation; category and city balance; founding seats held by activated professionals; promotion delivered with proof (if programme terms are final)
Budget	Tier 0–2 only after proof. No ads for seller acquisition before launch

Item	Plan
Stop / continue	Campaign rules; launch readiness of the seller journey confirmed by the founder
Activation goals	Complete pods in at least two anchor cities before launch. Every activated professional's first listing reviewed for quality
Review cadence	Weekly review. Fortnightly founder decision review. Launch go/no-go for seller communications

9. Budget discipline

Principle: spend time before money, and money only after a channel has proven activations on 40 or more contacts.

Tier	What	Why
Tier 0 — time only (do first)	1:1 outreach from the database; Wave –1 friendly professionals; peer introductions; enrichment by team hours; set-up calls; founder notes to anchors	Highest learning and conversion per rupee
Tier 1 — small, enabling	Domain email and authentication; one simple approved page; a professional Instagram with real content; local travel to anchors in Delhi NCR/Mumbai	Removes credibility and deliverability barriers
Tier 2 — only after proof	AiSensy subscription (once 50 or more opted in); a LinkedIn paid tier only if practices convert; small professional events in anchor cities once a pod exists to show	Scales what already works

Where money should NOT be spent:

- Paid ads or boosted posts to recruit sellers before launch.
- Buying or renting contact lists, enrichment databases or scraping tools. Uploading the prospect database to any ad, bulk email or WhatsApp tool.
- Bulk WhatsApp/SMS, or BSP fees before there are opt-ins.
- Celebrity or influencer fees; paid testimonials.
- PR agency retainers (the PR strategy found no agency with evidenced creator-economy work).
- Cinematic video production (the legacy Luma campaign).
- Trade-fair booths and sponsorships before pods exist.
- CRM or automation software (the Command Center is enough at this scale).
- Cash referral rewards, or discounts beyond what the founder has decided.

The Command Center's **BUDGET** sheet classifies every spend line. "NOT ALLOWED" must total zero.

10. Team, rhythm and capacity

Role	Owns	Time sink to guard against
Founder	Gate decisions; Wave –1; anchors and tier C notes; L2 escalations; one monthly founding session; approval of public numbers	Signing every message; per-category sessions; doing onboarding
Outreach lead	Route verification on the day; personalised first contacts; replies; follow-ups (the Command Center's DUE column); suppression list	Volume over quality
Onboarding lead (can be the same person in Waves –1 and 0)	Set-up calls; registration help; profile and first-listing drafts; escalations; activation records	Leaving professionals to self-serve

Daily (15 minutes): DUE follow-ups · new replies · STUCK alerts · today's pod batch.

Weekly (60 minutes, Friday):

- campaign dashboard and stop/scale statuses;
- weekly cohorts;
- category and city balance;
- defects and escalations;
- gate status;
- decisions needed.

Capacity rule: new first contacts per week $\leq$ set-up calls available per week $\div$ observed interest rate. Until measured, 10 or fewer new contacts per person per day.

11. Measurement and stop/continue rules

All thresholds are **test thresholds**, editable in the Command Center **SETTINGS**.

Rule	Trigger	Action
Bounce	Above 5% in a campaign (10 or more contacts)	Stop; re-verify routes
Opt-out / complaint	Above 2%, or any platform warning	Stop the channel; founder review
Reply	Below 10% after 40 delivered	Stop and rework message/segment before more volume
Scale	Reply at 20% or more with activations	Double the weekly allocation within capacity
Interested → registered	Below 30% (10 or more interested)	Fix registration friction (payment, form, terms clarity)
Registered → approved	Below 70%, or median above 3 days	Escalate the admin process
Approved → activated	Below 50%	Pause new contacts; assisted onboarding
Category share	Any category above 30% of activated	Rebalance
GST-flagged activations	Any	Founder + CA policy (G4)

North star: activated professionals. **Ultimate:** transacting professionals after launch. Messages sent are never reported without activations beside them.

12. What to read, what to ignore

Use daily	Use as reference	Do not use for sequencing
This playbook; Command Center; Final Checklist; Seller Objection Playbook	Onboarding Playbook; Founding Programme design; Who-has-joined framework; Referral framework; Message Engine (M3, objection replies, segment lines); Category and City playbooks; Source audit	v1 First 25/100/300 lists (superseded by Golden 300 v2); v1 M1 first messages (superseded by the rewrites); Activation Checklist tracker and list trackers (superseded by the Command Center)

13. Final verdict

AMBER — execution possible, but specific blockers must be resolved.

- **May start now:** Gate 0 sprint; the Wave –1 journey test once G6 is closed.
- **Wave 0 (first cold outreach) requires:** G1, G2, G3, G4, G7, G13 closed.
- **Wave 1 requires additionally:** G5, G8, G9, G10, G11 (for service segments), G12.